

Ecclesiastical Latin

EL-A4: Rhetoric and Periodic Prose

Prove a rhetorical pattern from exact grammatical members and explain how it orders, delays, balances, or foregrounds thought

Stage	Stage IV — Advanced Reading and Composition
Prerequisite	EL-A3 and complete syntactic control of long prayer periods
Next	EL-A5, Textual Comparison and Commentary

Read *EL-GUIDE: Start Here* before using this packet. Course method, pacing, source conventions, and answer protocol are stated there; this module begins with its lesson and assumes previously taught terms.

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Part I

Lesson

CHAPTER 1

A4. Rhetoric and periodic prose

Rhetorical analysis explains how arrangement guides attention and memory. It does not decorate a grammatical paraphrase with Greek labels.

Rhetoric here means the purposeful arrangement of language to shape a hearer's or reader's attention, judgment, and response. A **figure** is a recognizable pattern of wording or structure; naming one is only the beginning of analysis. Its **effect** is the contribution that the pattern makes in this passage, established from syntax and context rather than assigned from a memorized list.

On completing this unit, you can:

- identify parallelism, anaphora, antithesis, climax, hyperbaton, and periodic suspension;
- connect a figure to syntax and semantic effect;
- diagram a long preface or Canon sentence; and
- reproduce selected patterns in controlled prose.

1.1 A functional inventory

Figure	Definition and test	Possible work
Anaphora	repetition of the same word or phrase at the beginning of successive corresponding members	binds petitions or assertions into a cumulative act
Parallelism	two or more members with corresponding grammatical structure; correspondence must be shown, not merely asserted	makes likeness, contrast, or progression perceptible
Antithesis	semantic opposition sharpened by parallel or balanced structure; opposition without structural correspondence is not yet this figure	focuses a theological or moral distinction
Tricolon	a sequence of three corresponding members, whether or not they increase	gives a threefold sense of balance, range, or completion
Climax	members arranged in demonstrable increase of force, scope, or importance	creates ascent; three members alone prove only a tricolon

Figure	Definition and test	Possible work
Hyperbaton	separation of words that syntax binds closely, such as an adjective and noun, beyond their expected adjacency	can frame or foreground intervening material; rhetorical purpose still needs argument
Chiasm	two pairs arranged in inverted correspondence, schematically ABBA, with credible syntactic or semantic matching	concentrates reciprocal relation; four loosely related words do not establish it
Polyptoton	repetition of one lexeme in different inflected forms within a short span	varies grammatical relation while preserving visible verbal identity
Period	a sentence whose governing construction remains suspended while subordinate members accumulate toward completion	orders grounds, petition, and end toward the main resolution

Worked example: deictic accumulation in the Canon

Worked passage ID: W.IV.5; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

Hæc dona, hæc munera, hæc sancta sacrificia illibata repeats *hæc* and develops three accusative objects, the last expanded by two adjectives. The sequence does not present three disconnected dictionary glosses; its anaphora and growing weight focus the objects of *habeas et benedicas*. A useful note connects repetition, morphology, and the governing verbs.

Worked example: the preface frame

Worked passage ID: W.IV.6; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

Vere dignum et iustum est, æquum et salutare coordinates two pairs of predicate adjectives around *est*; the following infinitive or substantive action states what is fitting. Before translating, bracket the predicate frame and trace how the longer sentence suspends completion through relative clauses before the angelic conclusion.

1.2 Prose rhythm

Cadence is the patterned movement toward a phrase or sentence ending; a **clausula** is a recognizable closing cadence, especially one described by conventional metrical or stress patterns. Because identifying a clausula requires more than noticing that a sentence ends neatly, claims here must cite a reference pattern and the relevant textual quantities or stresses.

Advanced commentary may observe cadence and clausula, but this course makes no pronunciation requirement and therefore treats rhythm through textual pattern, stress information from references, and comparison—not unsupported claims based on private recitation. Rhetorical structure remains available on the page through balance, length, recurrence, and closure.

Part II

Practice

CHAPTER 1

Transfer, retrieval, and application

1.1 A functional inventory — transfer practice

Connection. The same visible repetition may serve balance, accumulation, contrast, or closure depending on its grammatical members.

Transfer task. Choose one figure already printed in the lesson and fill four rows: exact form, syntactic role, corresponding member, and local development.

Retrieval check. Remove the figure's name and explain whether the analysis remains intelligible.

1.2 Prose rhythm — transfer practice

Connection. A cautious rhythm note begins with clause boundaries, stress or sound observations, and a reproducible comparison rather than a vague claim of solemnity.

Transfer task. On the lesson's period, mark syntactic cola and repeated sounds, then write one claim you can support and one stronger historical or metrical claim you must withhold.

Retrieval check. Identify the grammatical boundary that anchors each proposed colon.

1.3 Worked period process — transfer practice

Connection. A full process moves from verbs to dependencies to rhetorical function.

Transfer task. Using the complete period selected for Worksheet IV.14, produce four layers: verbal inventory, indented clause tree, parallel-member overlay, and three-sentence functional account.

Retrieval check. Which layer must be correct before a claim of suspension can pass?

Part III

Worksheets

CHAPTER 1

A4 worksheet family: rhetoric

Worksheet IV.14 — Diagramming a period

Worksheet ID: IV.14

Focus: Make long syntax visible.

Use: Use a complete preface or Canon sentence.

1. Copy the sentence and underline every finite verb twice, every non-finite verb once.

-
2. Place each subordinate clause on an indented line beneath its governor.

-
3. Circle the main-clause completion and explain what delays it.

-
4. Mark parallel members and any framing word order.

-
5. Write a prose account of how suspension orders the thought.
-

Worksheet IV.16 — Rhetoric gate**Worksheet ID:** IV.16**Focus:** Analyze without overclaiming.**Use:** Use an unfamiliar chant and prayer.

1. **Text:** *Vere dignum et iustum est, æquum et salutare.*

Passage ID: IV.16.1; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

Identify syntax and balance.

-
2. What must be supplied or follow for the semantic content of “it”?

-
3. **Text:** *Dies iræ, dies illa, solvet sæclum in favilla.*

Passage ID: IV.16.2; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

Identify repetition, demonstrative reference, and clause spine.

-
4. Why does poetic order not cancel syntax?

-
5. Write one paragraph connecting two figures to the meaning of either passage.
-

Part IV

Assessment

CHAPTER 1

Mastery assessment and record

Advance when: On an unfamiliar prayer period, account for every clause and non-finite form, prove each proposed figure from corresponding Latin members, and explain its local function rather than merely naming terminology.

Complete the assessment before opening the answer part. Record evidence, not confidence or elapsed time.

Evidence	First attempt	Delayed check
Date and conditions		
Worksheet ID and score		
Mastery task and result		
One recurring error family		
Correction stated as a rule		
Unseen or remediation item used		

If the criterion is met: continue to EL-A5, Textual Comparison and Commentary.

If it is not met: Worksheets IV.13 and IV.15 remain optional figure-diagnostic and rhetorical-imitation practice.

Advance / remediate decision: _____ **Next review date:** _____

Reason in one complete sentence: _____

Part V

Answer Key

Open this part only after completing the assessment record. Use the comparison and alternative-answer protocol in EL-GUIDE.

CHAPTER 1

Practice models and rubrics

A functional inventory — model and rubric

Model / acceptable evidence. A strong model still identifies what repeats or reverses, how members correspond, and what changes across them. If the account collapses without the label, it has not shown function.

Prose rhythm — model and rubric

Model / acceptable evidence. The model aligns cola with finite or subordinate units and cites audible or visual recurrence. It withholds quantitative, authorial, or causal conclusions not established by the course evidence.

Worked period process — model and rubric

Model / acceptable evidence. The clause tree must correctly locate the main completion and every dependent before the overlay or functional account is scored. Suspension is proved by the grammatical material delaying that completion.

CHAPTER 2

A4 worksheet family: rhetoric

Solution IV.14 — Diagramming a period

Worksheet ID: IV.14

Focus: Make long syntax visible.

Use: Use a complete preface or Canon sentence.

1. Copy the sentence and underline every finite verb twice, every non-finite verb once.
Answer / model: Key is passage-specific; all finite verbs, infinitives, and participles must be accounted for before diagramming.
2. Place each subordinate clause on an indented line beneath its governor.
Answer / model: Require explicit labels for relative, purpose, substantive, temporal, or other relation; indentation without classification is incomplete.
3. Circle the main-clause completion and explain what delays it.
Answer / model: Identify the main predicate/petition and list intervening relative, participial, appositional, or coordinated material.
4. Mark parallel members and any framing word order.
Answer / model: The answer must cite exact corresponding forms; do not award labels based only on English translation.
5. Write a prose account of how suspension orders the thought.
Answer / model: Model: explain what grounds precede petition/assertion, where expectation is held, and how the main resolution gathers the subordinate material.

Solution IV.16 — Rhetoric gate

Worksheet ID: IV.16

Focus: Analyze without overclaiming.

Use: Use an unfamiliar chant and prayer.

1. **Text:** *Vere dignum et iustum est, æquum et salutare.*

Passage ID: IV.16.1; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

Identify syntax and balance.

Answer / notes: Impersonal/predicate construction with *est*; four neuter singular predicate adjectives in two coordinated pairs, balanced as *dignum et iustum* / *æquum et salutare*.

2. What must be supplied or follow for the semantic content of “it”?

Answer / model: An infinitive or substantive act in the larger preface states what is fitting; the opening frame anticipates that completion.

3. **Text:** *Dies iræ, dies illa, solvet sæclum in favilla.*

Passage ID: IV.16.2; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

Identify repetition, demonstrative reference, and clause spine.

Answer / notes: Anaphora/repetition of *dies*; *illa* agrees with the second *dies*; *dies* is subject, *solvet* future active, *sæclum* object, *in favilla* prepositional phrase.

4. Why does poetic order not cancel syntax?

Answer / model: Endings and agreement still establish relations; meter/rhyme/foregrounding can rearrange constituents but do not remove morphology.

5. Write one paragraph connecting two figures to the meaning of either passage.

Answer / model: A successful answer names exact forms, proves their syntax, and explains emphasis, balance, dread, or closure; a list of terms earns no credit.

Part VI

Scope and Sources

CHAPTER 1

Scope and Qualifications

1.1 Packet boundary

This is module EL-A4, *Rhetoric and Periodic Prose*, in Triptych's print-first Ecclesiastical Latin curriculum. It imports one authoritative lesson, transfer practice for its internal submodules, two selected worksheets, one local mastery assessment, and matching solutions. The packet treats literary function in selected prose and chant; it does not make unsupported claims about quantitative clausulae or authorial intention.

The unprinted worksheet variants remain course-owned extension material; their omission is intentional and is not a claim that the module exhausts available practice. EL-GUIDE owns the course-wide study method, pacing, lookup discipline, answer protocol, source classes, and advancement rules; this packet assumes that orientation and terminology taught in prerequisite modules.

1.2 Controlling records and local state

Course-wide research records own the edition, passage, answer, curriculum, and source decisions; the leaf's module map records this packet's selection and transfer practice. EL-GUIDE owns the corpus, normalization, translation, non-authority, review, and answer conventions that apply here. Claim-local qualifications remain beside the affected material; check received wording against the course-wide passage inventory.

Any installed snapshot is a working study held from release until its exact bytes and outstanding distribution gates receive separate authorization.

CHAPTER 2

References

The following works are the course's controlling corpus and reference aids. Project-composed explanation, translation, analysis, exercises, and models are distinguished from received wording under the convention stated in the Scope and Qualifications appendix. Short source passages are identified so that the learner can verify their wider context. The adjacent edition manifest and passage inventory record exact source roles, checks, access states, and known rights limits.

2.1 Primary corpus

- Catholic Church, *Missale Romanum ex decreto SS. Concilii Tridentini restitutum, Summorum Pontificum cura recognitum*, editio typica (Rome, 1962). A searchable presentation of the edition is hosted by the Holy See's Biblia Clerus project: <https://www.clerus.org/bibliaclerusonline/EN/gmb.htm>.
- A page-image scan of the 1962 typical edition is available through the Church Music Association of America: <https://media.churchmusicassociation.org/pdf/missale62.pdf>. Page images, rather than unsourced transcriptions, should decide doubtful punctuation or spelling.

- The Clementine Vulgate is the principal biblical comparison corpus. The public-domain 1914 edition edited by Michael Hetzenauer and its provenance are described at <https://www.sacredbible.org/vulgate1914/>.

2.2 Grammar and lexicography

- J. H. Allen and J. B. Greenough, *New Latin Grammar for Schools and Colleges* (1903), a donor-declared public-domain reference whose digital locator was not independently consulted during integration: <https://archive.org/details/allengreenoughsn01alle>.
- Charles E. Bennett, *New Latin Grammar*, 1918 revision, Project Gutenberg eBook 15665; public-domain text in the United States: <https://www.gutenberg.org/ebooks/15665>.
- Charlton T. Lewis and Charles Short, *A Latin Dictionary* (1879), searchable transcription: <https://logeion.uchicago.edu/lexidium>.
- Charles du Fresne, sieur du Cange, *Glossarium mediae et infimae latinitatis*, a donor-declared later-vocabulary aid whose digital locator was not independently consulted during integration: <http://ducange.enc.sorbonne.fr/>.

The underlying 1903, 1918, 1879, and 1883–1887 printed works are public domain in the United States. Digital transcriptions and interfaces retain their own terms and are cited as access tools, not relicensed or reproduced wholesale. The 1962 Missal, Scripture, official text, and other received wording retain their own status; see the scope appendix, research records, and final-page rights notice.

Classical reference grammars describe the inherited system but do not by themselves explain every biblical or ecclesiastical development. The advanced volume therefore distinguishes classical baseline, Vulgate usage, later Christian usage, and stable liturgical formula instead of labeling every difference an “exception.”

2.3 Citation convention

Missal passages are cited by liturgical location and text genre rather than by a page number that varies among printings. Biblical texts are cited by book, chapter, and verse. Historical authors are cited by work and section wherever possible. A learner preparing a formal commentary should verify each passage against the edition actually being used and record any variant. These references are not a claim that every historical-linguistic question can be settled by the listed school grammars and dictionary interfaces.

CHAPTER 3

Generation Metadata

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Model: GPT-5-based Codex agent; unexposed: exact model identifier and model qualifiers

Agent/runtime: OpenAI Codex agents (curriculum architecture, module design, enrichment, source and answer audit, correction, production, and review); Codex CLI 0.144.6; API workspace; unexposed: server revision

Agent/runtime: OpenAI Codex agents (whole-curriculum structure audit, shared typesetting and selection correction, rendered-structure regression checks, production, and review); Codex CLI 0.144.6; API workspace; unexposed: server revision

Agent/runtime: OpenAI Codex agents (whole-curriculum Part-scoped numbering and rendered contents hierarchy correction, rendered contents-geometry regression checking, production, and review); Codex CLI 0.144.6; API workspace; unexposed: server revision

Agent/runtime: OpenAI Codex agents (starter-guide consolidation, module-flow and definition-retrieval revision, stage-boundary assessment correction, catalog and audit records, production, and review); Codex CLI 0.144.6; API workspace; unexposed: server revision

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